

STUDY GUIDE HISTORICAL UNGA



Agenda : 47th Session - Addressing
the Situation in the Territory of Former
Yugoslavia





Letter from R&D

Dear Delegates,

The Department of Research & Development of MUNSociety MPSTME welcomes you to the 11th edition of Mumbai MUN! Our department upholds a proud tradition of facilitating meaningful discourse on national and international matters, encompassing both historical events and current issues.

We are primarily tasked with formulating agendas and preparing comprehensive study guides. We have created detailed and engaging guides aimed at providing valuable resources for all delegates.

This year's theme, "Redefine the Norm," challenges us to think beyond conventional solutions and embrace innovative approaches to global challenges. In a rapidly evolving world, traditional methods often fall short of addressing contemporary issues. We believe that transformative change requires the courage to question established practices and the creativity to envision alternative pathways.

With this theme in mind, we have thoroughly picked agendas and committees that demand fresh perspectives, challenge conventional thought, and encourage innovative approaches to problem-solving. In this study guide, you will find well-researched background information to help you prepare for your committee sessions.

We, as facilitators, aim to provide you with the intellectual arsenal to combat any challenges that you might face and make the most of your Mumbai MUN experience.

We look forward to your active participation and contributions during Mumbai MUN and are confident that, together, we can make this conference a memorable and enriching experience for all.

Best wishes,

Department of Research & Development,
MUNSociety MPSTME.

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Agenda: 47th Session - Addressing the Situation in the Territory of Former Yugoslavia

Freeze Date: 14 September, 1993

COMMITTEE OVERVIEW

The General Assembly

The United Nations General Assembly (UNGA) is one of the six main organs of the United Nations (UN). It serves as the primary deliberative, policy-making and representative body of the UN. Established in 1945, the UNGA is a forum for all member states to engage in dialogue and decision-making. The UNGA gives each nation equal representation, with one vote per member state.

The UNGA is responsible for discussing various issues, including global peace and security, economic development, human rights, environmental sustainability, decolonisation, and social justice. While the UNGA can only pass resolutions that are advisory.¹

The UNGA has the right to convene an Emergency Special Session within 24 hours when an international crisis emerges and the Security Council fails to act due to a veto. The General Assembly can also call for an Emergency Special Session at the request of a member state or the United Nations Secretary-General. The UNGA can recommend a range of actions to address a situation including humanitarian aid, sanctions, peacekeeping missions and other measures aimed at resolving the issue.²

The 47TH Session

The 47th Session of the UNGA convened between 1992 and 1993, this was a pivotal time following the recent end of the Cold War. The UNGA focused on a wide range of issues from combating poverty and promoting sustainable development to addressing key security challenges. One of the key issues raised during the session was addressing the ongoing crisis caused by the Yugoslav Wars. By resolution 47/1, the UNGA adopted the decision to not permit the Federal Republic of Yugoslavia (FRY - Serbia and Montenegro) to inherit the UN membership of the former Socialist Federal Republic of Yugoslavia. Instead, the FRY would be required to apply for new membership and barred from participating in the General Assembly until the membership was granted.³

INTRODUCTION

The Socialist Federation of Yugoslavia consisted of six republics, namely Serbia, Croatia, Slovenia, Bosnia and Herzegovina, Montenegro, and Macedonia, with two autonomous provinces Kosovo and Vojvodina. Ethnic and social tensions were repressed under the premiership of Josip Broz Tito, who ruled the state from 1945 till 1980, however, these tensions saw a resurgence after his death. These tensions were fuelled by several factors, including nationalist movements, power struggles, and economic and political instability.

¹ United Nations. (n.d.). Functions and powers of the General Assembly. Retrieved from <https://www.un.org/en/ga/about/background.shtml>

² United Nations. (n.d.-b). UN General Assembly - Emergency special sessions. Retrieved from <https://www.un.org/en/ga/sessions/emergency.shtml#:~:text=If%20not%20in%20session%20at,Members%20of%20the%20United%20Nations%22>

³ UN Resolution 47/1. (n.d.). <https://documents-dds-ny.un.org/doc/RESOLUTION/GEN/NR0/023/69/IMG/NR002369.pdf?OpenElement=>

Ethnic tensions led to the central authority being weakened, causing nationalist movements across the country to call for independence and partition. This sparked the beginning of the Yugoslav Wars, which saw several brutal atrocities being committed, including ethnic cleansing, mass executions, sexual violence, and genocide.⁴



Map of the Socialist Federal Republic of Yugoslavia
(1991)
Source: ICTY

To keep these war crimes under control, The International Criminal Tribunal for the former Yugoslavia (ICTY) was established. This tribunal was responsible for enforcing international humanitarian law and prosecuting those who violated those laws. This ensured that breaches of international law would be limited, and everyone from low-ranking soldiers to high-level officials would be held responsible for war crimes.⁵

BACKGROUND

Yugoslavism

The Balkans is an area in South East Europe, with a great diversity in culture. For thousands of years, it has been home to various people, kingdoms and languages and has significant strategic value as it sits near the Center of Europe with quick access to the Middle East and North Africa. Unfortunately, this diversity in culture and key strategic location also made the region prone to annexation.

Throughout centuries, foreign powers including the Romans, Ottomans, Byzantines and Austrians have repeatedly invaded the region but the majority of people of the Western Balkans (places that would later form Yugoslavia) were Slavic. In the late 17th Century, an idea of Slavic independence was beginning to brew, specifically in the South Slavs. This idea of independence called for the creation of a United Slav state that was devoted to brotherhood and protection from foreign tyranny. This ideology came to be known as Yugoslavism and it firmly believed that all Slavs should be free from their oppressors.

Throughout the 18th century, intellectuals from Croatia and Serbia threw around plans for the creation of Yugoslavia. This country was supposed to be a Federation of different Slavic groups where each nation would keep its ethnic identity while simultaneously sharing Yugoslav as a national identity. This country would attempt to foster brotherhood by regarding all the Slavs as equals irrespective of religion.⁶

⁴Yugoslavia: History, Background Flag, Map and Breakup. (n.d.-b). <https://www.britannica.com/place/Yugoslavia-former-federated-nation-1929-2003>

⁵About the ICTY. About the ICTY | International Criminal Tribunal for the former Yugoslavia. (n.d.). <https://www.icty.org/en/about>

⁶Modernism: The creation of nation-states - yugoslavism - central european university press. (n.d.-f). <https://books.openedition.org/ceup/1963?lang=en>

Formation of Yugoslavia

In the late 19th century, Serbia, after almost five centuries of oppression, declared war (known as the "Yugoslavian Wars of Succession") on the Ottoman Empire and secured their independence in 1878. This war also led to Montenegro gaining independence. While this was a step towards Slavic independence, the surrounding regions of future Croatia and Slovenia were still under the control of the Austro-Hungarian Empire. This control over these regions was disputed by other foreign powers like the UK, Italy, Russia and any other Empire that sought to increase its sphere of influence. Due to these factors and the escalating tensions between Balkan nations themselves, the region became notoriously known as "The Powder Keg of Europe".⁷

Unfortunately, this "Powder of Keg" finally exploded on 28 June 1914, when Archduke Franz Ferdinand, heir presumptive to the Austrian-Hungarian Empire throne, was assassinated by an extremist group of Bosnian Serbs in Sarajevo, Bosnia.⁸ This assassination catapulted Europe straight into the First World War.⁹

As an aftermath of WW1, the Austro-Hungarian Empire collapsed and Austria lost control over its Balkan neighbours. This immediately gave birth to a South Slavic nation (The state of Slovenes, Croats and Serbs) which only after thirty-three days of its formation, signed the Corfu

Declaration with Serbia and Montenegro, merging with them to form the Kingdom of Serbs, Croats and Slovenes which would be known as Yugoslavia.¹⁰

Yugoslavia During WW2

However, this victory was short-lived. At the onset of WW2, Prince Paul, the regent of Yugoslavia, understood the dangers posed by expansionist Nazi Germany especially considering the poorly equipped Yugoslavian army and an underperforming economy. Fearing a conflict with the Axis, Prince Paul decided to give in to the Axis' demands by signing the Tripartite Pact on 21 March 1941. While this pact would secure Yugoslavian independence and keep them out of the war, it failed to gain popularity among the masses. Protests and riots began the same night of signing the pact with chants like "Better a war than a pact, better the grave than a slave". Within two days of signing the pact, Prince Paul was overthrown by a military coup led by General Dusan Simovic and supported by the British Empire. The new administration declared seventeen-year-old Peter II, legally of age, to rule Yugoslavia. The country would also be withdrawing from the

⁷Serbia's Great War. (n.d.-c).

<https://web.archive.org/web/20120303154152/http://www.historicalreview.org/index.php/historicalReview/article/viewFile/233/129>

⁸McLean, J. (n.d.). *History of Western Civilization II*. The Balkan Powder Keg | History of Western Civilization II.

<https://courses.lumenlearning.com/suny-hccc-worldhistory2/chapter/the-balkan-powder-keg/>

⁹Assassination of Archduke Franz Ferdinand. (n.d.-a). <https://guides.loc.gov/chronicling-america-assassination-franz-ferdinand#:~:text=Historic%20American%20Newspapers,-,Two%20shots%20in%20Sarajevo%20ignited%20the%20fires%20of%20war%20and,are%20killed%20by%20Gavrilo%20Princip.>

¹⁰ WW1 and Yugoslavia. (n.d.-e). <https://encyclopedia.1914-1918-online.net/article/yugoslavia/>

Tripartite Pact which it signed with the Axis powers.¹¹

Despite support from the Yugoslavians and the international community, standing up against the Axis came with a cost. Hitler was furious upon learning about this coup and the inauguration of Peter II. Germany was worried that Yugoslavia could be used by the Allied forces as an airbase to carry out offensive operations against Germany. Hitler immediately issued Fuhrer Directive 25 which authorised the German forces to invade Yugoslavia.

On 6 April 1941, Yugoslavia was invaded by German forces backed by Italy, Bulgaria and Hungary launched a ground invasion against Yugoslavia and Greece. Yugoslavia failed to compete with such forces and was forced to surrender while Peter II fled the country. Yugoslavia was no more, the terms of surrender fragmented Yugoslavia and parts of it were given under the control of neighbouring countries with puppet governments set up in every republic. This was followed by a skyrocket in the death toll in the region as pro-axis groups started executing anyone who had resentment against them while the Axis forces killed thousands under the pretext of suppressing riots. But the worst part about this was the ethnic cleansing that followed.



Yugoslavian resistance against Axis Powers
Source: UN

Following the invasion, Yugoslavia was partitioned. Croatia declared independence as the Independent State of Croatia (NDH) under the fascist Ustaše regime, which was a puppet state of Nazi Germany. This regime, led by Ante Pavelić, implemented an extreme fascist agenda, including the mass killing and ethnic cleansing of Serbs, Jews, and Roma, and established concentration camps such as Jasenovac. The rest of the country, including Serbia, was occupied by Nazi Germany, while parts of Bosnia and Herzegovina, Slovenia, and Macedonia were annexed by neighbouring Axis powers, including Hungary, Bulgaria, and Italy.¹²

Reformation of Yugoslavia

In response to the occupation, two main resistance movements emerged. The Chetniks, led by Draža Mihailović, was a royalist and nationalist Serbian group that initially fought against the Axis powers. However, as the war progressed, the Chetniks increasingly focused on fighting the communist Partisans rather than the Germans. This internal strife between Serbs made the Chetniks a controversial force. On the other hand, the Partisans, led by Josip Broz Tito,

¹¹U.S. Department of State. (n.d.). *Price Paul Sign the Tripartite Pact: US Office of Historians*. U.S. Department of State. <https://history.state.gov/historicaldocuments/frus1941v02/d957>

¹² United States Holocaust Memorial Museum. (n.d.). Axis invasion of Yugoslavia. <https://encyclopedia.ushmm.org/content/en/article/axis-invasion-of-yugoslavia>

embraced a more inclusive vision, calling for a federal and socialist Yugoslavia that would unite all South Slavic peoples. Tito's forces, composed of communists, anti-fascists, and various ethnic groups, launched a sustained guerrilla war against both the Axis occupiers and the Chetniks.

The Axis powers, meanwhile, continued their brutal occupation, with the Ustaše regime implementing widespread atrocities, including the systematic massacre of Serbs, Jews, and Roma in concentration camps and killing fields. The conflict between the Chetniks and Partisans also grew more intense, with both sides committing atrocities. The Partisans, however, gained the upper hand over time, establishing liberated territories and increasing their control across Yugoslavia. The Partisan forces gradually became the dominant resistance group, pushing both the Axis forces and their local collaborators out of Yugoslavia.

By 1944, as the war turned in favour of the Allies, Tito's Partisans had liberated significant parts of Yugoslavia, and by 1945, they had succeeded in liberating the entire country. The Partisans, with Soviet support, expelled the German and Italian forces, and in November 1945, Tito declared the formation of the Federal People's Republic of Yugoslavia. Tito became its leader, and the country was reconstituted as a communist federation, which would later be renamed the Socialist Federal Republic of Yugoslavia.¹³

Fall of Yugoslavia

Although Tito's regime stabilised the country and eventually joined the non-aligned movement, there was a death toll of at least a million people in Yugoslavia between 1941 and 1945 with some estimates going as high as 1.7 million. These deaths were not only caused by Axis occupation but also by ethnic cleansing by fascist Croats and nationalist Serbs. These scars caused ethnic

division and a lack of cohesive national identity which would set the stage for the eventual breakup of Yugoslavia.

The Socialist Federal Republic of Yugoslavia consisted of six republics namely Slovenia, Croatia, Serbia, Bosnia and Herzegovina, Macedonia and Montenegro. Furthermore, each of these republics had their own Constitution, Prime Minister and Supreme Court. This caused a difference in laws followed and a difference in the beliefs of each republic. While Tito's rule had brought economic growth to the nation in the 1950s and 60s it was debt-fueled and relied too much on foreign aid provided by both the Soviets and the United States of America. After Tito died in 1980 the Cold War slowly wound down. Foreign aid started disappearing while Yugoslavia had amassed a huge debt. This caused inflation to rise to the dismay of Slovenia and Croatia who were much more financially stable than the other republics and fostered a sense of resentment towards the Southern Republics for being unproductive. Meanwhile, the other republics had unemployment and economic problems which gave rise to nationalism making each republic invest in their people rather than in Yugoslavia as a whole. This in turn made the Republics lean towards a demand for autonomy. This rise in nationalism gave way to ethnic clashes in various parts of the Socialist Federal Republic.

The ethnic clashes in Kosovo between Serbs and Albanians in the late 1980s were a key factor that sparked the Anti-Bureaucratic Revolution, a political movement led by Slobodan Milošević to centralise power in Yugoslavia, particularly under Serbian control. Kosovo, a province within Serbia, had a majority ethnic Albanian population, but its historical and cultural significance to Serbs made it a point of intense nationalist sentiment. Tensions escalated in the mid-1980s as Kosovo Albanians demanded greater autonomy and

¹³ Reformation of Yugoslavia. (n.d.-g). <https://www.britannica.com/topic/Partisan-Yugoslavian-military-force>

rights, while Serbs in Kosovo felt increasingly marginalised and called for protection from what they saw as Albanian domination. Milošević capitalised on these rising ethnic tensions to boost his political standing, positioning himself as a defender of Serbs everywhere. Milošević eventually became the President and his ambitions to centralise power in Serbia were not liked by Croatia and Slovenia who already resented his nationalistic approach.

Slovenia

Slovenia became the first of the six republics to formally leave Yugoslavia. It declared independence on 24 June 1991, which triggered an intervention by the Yugoslav People's Army (JNA). The JNA had mainly become a Serbian Nationalistic Army and failed to represent Yugoslavia as a whole. This intervention turned into a military conflict now known as the "Ten Day War" which ended with the Slovenian Forces compelling the JNA to retreat despite being heavily outnumbered.

CROATIA

Croatia, just like Slovenia, declared independence on 24 June 1991. Unlike Slovenia, it came at the cost of a lot of bloodshed. This was due to the presence of a sizable ethnic Serb minority in Croatia who protested against the newly independent Croatia authority. These minorities, with the help of Serbia and the JNA, took nearly a third of Croatia's territory under their control and declared themselves as an independent Serb state. The Croats and other non-Serbs were forcefully displaced from the captured territory by fear and means like ethnic cleansing, and targeting civilians. Following this, the UN on 20th June 1992 authorised the United Nations Protection Force (UNPROFOR) to carry out monitoring functions in the "pink zones" (certain areas of Croatia controlled by the JNA

and populated mostly by the Serbs but which were outside the agreed United Nations Protected Areas (UNPA) boundaries, implementing a ceasefire.

Bosnia and Herzegovina

The situation in Bosnia and Herzegovina was complicated as it had a shared government representing its ethnic composition of 43% Bosnian Muslims, 33 per cent Bosnian Serbs, 17 per cent Bosnian Croats and the rest with other nationalists. Bosnia and Herzegovina lay at the centre of Yugoslavia making its strategic location of high importance to both Serbia and Croatia. In 1991, unbeknownst to the rest of the world, the leaders of Serbia and Croatia secretly agreed to divide the nation, leaving only a small region for the Muslim population.

In March 1992, a referendum was conducted in which more than 60% of Bosnian citizens voted in favour of independence. This overwhelming result was mainly due to the Bosnian Serbs boycotting the referendum. Almost immediately, in April 1992, the Bosnian Serbs launched a rebellion against the Bosnian government with the support of the Yugoslav People's Army and Serbia. Through overwhelming military superiority and a systematic campaign of persecution of non-Serbs, they quickly asserted control over more than 60% of the country. Seeing this, the Bosnian Serbs also rejected the authority of the Bosnian Government and declared their republic with the backing of Croatia. This escalated the conflict into a three-sided war, with civilians from all ethnic groups falling victim to horrific atrocities.¹⁴

¹⁴ *The conflicts*. The Conflicts | International Criminal Tribunal for the former Yugoslavia. (n.d.).
<https://www.icty.org/en/about/what-former-yugoslavia/conflicts>

CONSEQUENCES

Humanitarian Crisis

By June 1991, over 600,000 people were displaced, forcing many of them to seek refuge in neighbouring countries. Despite agreements to guarantee safe passage, many humanitarian organisations like the International Committee of the Red Cross (ICRC) faced difficulty in gaining access to certain areas to assist those in need. The resources of host families sheltering displaced individuals, especially those of neighbouring countries like Hungary, became increasingly strained as the crisis persisted.

Cities in regions where fighting occurred were devastated and left without any infrastructure. Running water, electricity, and fresh food were scarce, and telephone lines had been severed. Widespread property damage was evident, with houses and possessions left behind by fleeing residents destroyed.

Hungary

From the start of the conflict, Hungary had refused to close its borders with Yugoslavia for humanitarian purposes. By November of 1991, over 45,000 Yugoslavs had escaped to Hungary. The majority of them were Croats and ethnic Hungarians. A significant number of Yugoslavs had not registered as they chose to rely on friends and family instead of the Hungarian government. The number of Croats escaping to Hungary significantly increased after the JNA (Yugoslav National Army) took over Vukovar. Initially, Hungary only accepted the Yugoslavs temporarily, thus there was no decision taken to give them refugee status but as the crisis progressed, the situation turned into a permanent one with the escapees applying for authorization to stay as a migrant. There were even a huge amount of unaccompanied children

among the displaced population, who were sent to Hungary by their parents who remained in Yugoslav by choice or force. The Hungarian Red Cross set up many schools for these children with Croatian-speaking teachers. Despite having their resources largely stretched, the Hungarian Government did its best to protect these individuals, providing them with basic accommodation, pocket money and medical services. Seeing these efforts of Hungary, financial aid came from various other nations like Germany, Denmark and Japan.¹⁵

Austria

At the beginning of November 1991, between 6000 and 8000 Yugoslavs fled to Austria since they could enter without any formalities. Just like in Hungary, many of the displaced individuals stayed with their family and relatives living in Austria. The Austrian Ministry of Interior provided them with monetary aid and sickness coverage.¹⁵

Italy

An estimated 5,000 Yugoslavs tried to seek refuge in Italy. They were authorised to stay temporarily. The Italian government also prepared measures to take more of the displaced people. Tents and caravans were installed along the Adriatic coast to receive them.¹⁵

Others

During late 1991 and early 1992, many other European nations including Germany faced an influx of Yugoslav citizens. The exact number of these refugee seekers could not be established due to the quickly escalating developments in Yugoslavia. Since these escapees did not acquire a residence permit, there were instances of them being treated as illegal migrants.¹⁵

¹⁵ Crisis in Yugoslavia: Displaced Population. (n.d.-c). <https://assembly.coe.int/nw/xml/XRef/X2H-Xref-ViewHTML.asp?FileID=6887&lang=EN>

Political Implications

Fragmentation of Yugoslavia

Following the start of this conflict, Yugoslavia was fragmented into various republics. Slovenia, Croatia and Macedonia declared independence in 1991 followed by Bosnia and Herzegovina in 1992. The Republic of Srpska and Herzeg Bosnia also declared autonomy during the Bosnian War but failed to receive international recognition. Following the breakout of multiple wars, Serbia and Montenegro formed the Federal Republic of Yugoslavia (FRY) in April 1992 however this new federation was not seen as a successor of former Yugoslavia but as a remnant of the disintegrated state. These wars also left deep-rooted hatred within the once united ethnic groups which would increase tension in the region. These conflicts were further fueled by the rhetoric spread by nationalistic leaders.¹⁶

Rise of Ethnic Nationalism

The Yugoslav Wars ignited a fierce wave of nationalism and ethnic cleansing. Tito's death in 1980 left a power vacuum and gradually the communist control over the nation subsided causing the underlying ethnic tensions to resurface. Economic and political tensions started rising among the republics. These nationalist movements laid the groundwork for Yugoslavia's collapse. There were many documented cases of genocide, ethnic cleansing and targeted violence since the start of the conflict.

Diplomatic Efforts

Seeing the rising tensions, the international community has made multiple attempts in the past to resolve this conflict through dialogue and diplomacy.

The Hague Peace Conference

The Hague Peace Conference was the first European Conference that attempted to settle the conflict peacefully. It was chaired by Lord Carrington and sought to develop a plan that would encompass the entire Yugoslavia. It was based on the principle of ensuring independence to each of the republics and promised minority rights. Each of the republics voted in favour of this plan except Serbia. Later Serbia even persuaded Montenegro to reverse its vote. This was the last opportunity to resolve the dispute peacefully. Failure to convince all the republics resulted in a violent dissolution of Yugoslavia with bloodshed and long-lasting consequences.

The Lisbon Agreement

In February of 1992, Portugal as the chair of EC, facilitated talks between leaders of all ethnic parties regarding the conflict in Bosnia-Herzegovina. An agreement was signed by the leaders on 17 March 1992. This agreement organised Bosnia into three territorial units with power being shared between the Bosnian, Serbs and Croats. Unsatisfied with the partition of Bosnia and other nations promising to recognise Bosnia within its original boundaries, Izetbegovic, then President of Bosnia, withdrew from the agreement.

The Vance-Owen Plan

In August 1992, an attempt was made to resolve the situation at a conference in London. This conference created a permanent conference on Yugoslavia based in Geneva, the International Conference on Former Yugoslavia where David Owen represented the EC AND Cyrus Vance represented the UN. In January 1993, Vance and Owen presented a peace plan for Bosnia. It divided Bosnia into ten provinces each with ethnically mixed groups. It was an attempt to

¹⁶ U.S. Department of State. (n.d.). The Breakup of Yugoslavia. <https://history.state.gov/milestones/1989-1992/breakup-yugoslavia>

reduce ethnic tension in the region while maintaining the unified identity of Bosnia-Herzegovina.

This plan gained the support of President Milosevic, the Bosnian Serbs and Croats. Even the Bosnian government agreed with it reluctantly. However, the new U.S. administration failed to support it and was not prepared to provide on-ground required assistance. This withdrawal of support was followed by a slow backing out of European partners in NATO seeing which, the Bosnian Serb assembly rejected the plan.

The Owen-Stoltenberg Plan

In June 1993, at the conference chaired by David Owen and Thorvald Stoltenberg, Presidents Milosevic and Tadjman presented a reworked Vance Owen Plan, this time dividing Bosnia along ethnic lines. It called for the division of Bosnia into three republics which would form a union and have a federal constitution. This plan was immediately rejected by President Izetbegovic who was against partitioning Bosnia based on ethnicity.¹⁷

PAST INTERNATIONAL ACTION

United Nations Protection Force

Background

The conflict began in June 1991, after Slovenia and Croatia declared themselves independent from Yugoslavia. This was a result of the opposition of Serbs living in Croatia backed by the Yugoslav People's Army (JNA). Efforts taken by the European Community to stop hostilities and resolve this crisis failed. As a consequence, the United Nations had to step in and get actively involved in this situation in Yugoslavia. The first step was resolution 713 (1991) adopted by the Security Council, which expressed deep concern at the fighting in Yugoslavia. The resolution

called on all member states to restrict the delivery of weapons and military equipment to Yugoslavia.

The Secretary-General at the time, Javier Pérez de Cuéllar appointed the former United States Secretary of State, Mr Cyrus Vance, as his personal Envoy for Yugoslavia, on the 7 October 1991. Mr Cyrus Vance undertook several missions to Yugoslavia to discuss many topics with the parties concerned, especially the feasibility of deploying a United Nations peacekeeping operation in the region. On the 23 of November 1991, Mr Vance arranged for a meeting in Geneva. The Presidents of Serbia and Croatia, the Secretary of State for the National Defense of Yugoslavia and Lord Carrington, the Chairman of the European Community's Conference on Yugoslavia attended this meeting. In the meeting, the Yugoslav parties expressed the need for the deployment of a United Nations peacekeeping operation. The Security Council through resolution 721 (1991) acknowledged that the deployment of a United Nations peacekeeping force in Yugoslavia could only be done with the cooperation of all parties concerned. Following this resolution, the Security Council approved the Secretary-General's report which contained a plan for a possible peacekeeping operation, through resolution 724 (1991) on the 14 of December.

On 15 February 1992, even when certain political groups in Yugoslavia expressed objections to the United Nations plan, the Secretary-General recommended the Security Council establish the United Nations Protection Force (UNPROFOR), and he emphasised the dangers of the further delay in the dispatch of this peace-keeping force. More delays could result in the breakdown of the cease-fire between parties and could have grave consequences. Therefore, even with the lack of

¹⁷ Chapter 4 prospects for peace the ... (n.d.-d).

https://www.aph.gov.au/~media/wopapub/house/committee/jfadt/Bosnia/Bos_ch4_pdf.ashx

cooperation between parties, it was imperative for the deployment of this peacekeeping force.

The Security Council through resolution 743 (1992) on 21 February, approved the report of the Secretary-General and established the UNPROFOR initially, for 12 months. On 7 April, after receiving a report from the Secretary-General, that all the Force Commander's interlocutors had emphasised the need for the earliest possible deployment of UNPROFOR, the Security Council authorised the full deployment of the UNPROFOR.

Review of the UNPROFOR's Activities

Croatia

The Secretary-General's report described UNPROFOR's experience in Croatia as one of both success and failure. UNPROFOR's success was mainly achieved in ensuring the complete withdrawal of the Yugoslav People's Army (JNA) from Croatia, including the Prevlaka Peninsula. The presence of the UNPROFOR also helped prevent a recurrence of hostilities in the United Nations Protected Areas (UNPAs) and "pink zones". However, UNPROFOR had not been able to establish and maintain peace in the region that would have allowed the voluntary return of refugees and displaced persons to their homes. This was due to the non-cooperation of the local Serb authorities that had prevented the UNPROFOR from achieving the demilitarisation of the UNPAs and "pink zones", and the disarming of the Serb territorial Defence. Resolution 769 (1992) called for the establishment of border controls, which was not fulfilled by the UNPROFOR. Furthermore, the UNPROFOR was also not completely successful at preventing the discrimination and abuse of the human rights of the residents in the UNPAs, despite their best efforts.

Bosnia and Herzegovina

The UNPROFOR had a more limited mandate in Bosnia and Herzegovina, but still had some

notable contributions. Despite the interference of hostile military aircraft, the UNPROFOR succeeded in keeping the Sarajevo airport open. From 3 July 1992 to 31 January 1993, the UNHCR (United Nations High Commissioner for Refugees) organised a humanitarian airlift, and brought in 2,476 aircraft carrying 27,460 tons of food, medicines and other relief goods, while this aid was being delivered, the UNPROFOR was responsible for the protection of these goods, and their delivery. Even though there were many obstacles to the operation of protecting humanitarian convoys throughout this region due to mines, hostile fire and refusal of cooperation by parties on the ground such as the Bosnian Serb party, about 800,000 people benefited by about 34,600 tons of relief supplies, in 110 locations within the region of Bosnia and Herzegovina.

A ban on military flights had been implemented in the airspace of Bosnia and Herzegovina by the Security Council. This had been violated on nearly 400 occasions by all three parties, but it still achieved its main purpose of preventing the use of air power in military combat within the Republic of Bosnia and Herzegovina. Since the restrictions on the airspace had been placed by the Security Council, there had been no evidence found by UNPROFOR observers to suggest that any party had conducted any hostilities from the air, or conducted combat air missions.

Criticism faced by UNPROFOR's performance in the Republic for the most part has been due to its failure to fulfil tasks that the force had not been mandated, authorised, or equipped to fulfil.

Mandate Extensions

On 19 February 1993, the Security Council adopted resolution 807 (1993), which extended the mandate for an interim period until 31 March 1993, after taking into consideration the Secretary-General's report. The Council demanded parties to comply with the United Nations peace-keeping plans and to refrain from

positioning their forces near the United Nations Protected Areas (UNPAs) or “pink zones”.

On the 30th of March, just before the interim extension had elapsed, the Security Council adopted its resolution 815 (1993), which extended the mandate of UNPROFOR further, for an additional interim period until 30 June 1993. During this period the Secretary-General was preparing his report, in which he drew attention to the failure of parties to permit the implementation of the United Nations plan. He emphasised the presence of UNPROFOR as being indispensable for controlling the conflict and fostering peace. Taking this report into consideration, the Security Council decided to extend the mandate of the UNPROFOR, in resolution 847 (1993), for an additional interim period terminating on 30 September 1993.¹⁸

Formation of the Tribunal

The Yugoslav wars had forcefully displaced many people. After escaping, these people spoke about what happened to them. Many of their houses were burnt, the militaries indiscriminately targeted civilians and many communities were destroyed. The UN had to set a precedent, that no matter the situation, even in wars no one should be allowed to get away with committing crimes against humanity. After WW2, a tribunal had been set up to try and punish the German and Japanese leaders for the war crimes committed during the war. This prompted the German Foreign Minister to propose the formation of an International Tribunal for the war crimes committed in former Yugoslavia. To prevent controversies of victor justice like in the Nuremberg and Tokyo trials, it was decided that the tribunal would be formed by the UN itself.¹⁹

The tribunal was set up on May 24, 1993, when the UNSC formally established the International

Criminal Tribunal for the former Yugoslavia. This tribunal was authorised to prosecute all war crimes committed within Yugoslavia starting in 1991. This also implied that if an individual was found to have committed a crime before 1991 or outside Yugoslavia, they could not be tried in this tribunal. To determine what crimes individuals could be tried for, international law was taken into consideration e.g. the Geneva Convention and the Genocide Convention were both signed by Yugoslavia.

According to the International Criminal Tribunal for the former Yugoslavia (ICTY) Statute, individuals could be put on trial for: -

Grave Breaches of the Geneva Convention

The Geneva Convention was first signed on 22 August 1864 and was updated and revised several times in 1906, 1929 and 1949 finally coming into force on 21 October 1950. The convention describes certain acts as 'grave breaches' and requires all signatories to pursue any legislation required to enact effective penal sanctions for any person who has committed the 'grave breach'.

According to Article 2 of the ICTY Statute, the tribunal would have jurisdiction over these grave breaches: -

1. Wilful killing;
2. Torture or inhuman treatment, including biological experiments;
3. Wilfully causing great suffering or serious injury to body or health;
4. Extensive destruction and appropriation of property, not justified by military necessity and carried out unlawfully and wantonly;

¹⁸ United Nations. (n.d.-a). UNPROFOR. United Nations. https://peacekeeping.un.org/mission/past/unprof_b.htm

¹⁹ About the ICTY. About the ICTY | International Criminal Tribunal for the former Yugoslavia. (n.d.). <https://www.icty.org/en/about>

5. Compelling a prisoner of war or a civilian to serve in forces of a hostile power;
6. Wilfully depriving a prisoner of war or a civilian of the rights of fair and regular trial;
7. Unlawful deportation or transfer or unlawful confinement of a civilian;
8. Taking civilians as hostages.

Violations of the Laws or Customs of War

The laws or customs of war are a body of international law introduced through various international treaties, conventions and agreements, most notably the Hague Conventions of 1899 and 1907 the Geneva Conventions of 1949 and the Additional Protocols of 1977, as well as through the development of customary international law.

Article 3 of the ICTY Statute sets a list of violations punishable under its jurisdiction. The list includes violations like destroying places of religious and historical importance, employment of poisoned weapons, etc.

CRIMES AGAINST HUMANITY

The ICTY Statute would take inspiration from the Tokyo and Nuremberg trials and prosecute crimes against humanity. Article 5 of the ICTY Statute defined crimes against humanity as the following acts committed during an armed conflict, internal or international in character and directed against any civilian population: -

1. Murder;
2. Extermination;
3. Enslavement;

4. Deportation;
5. Imprisonment
6. Torture;
7. Rape;
8. Persecutions on political, racial and religious grounds;
9. Other inhumane acts.

Genocide

Article 4 of the ICTY Statute makes genocide punishable within its jurisdiction. It defines genocide as the following acts committed with the intent to destroy, in whole or in part, a national, ethnic or religious group: -

1. Killing members of the group;
2. causing serious bodily or mental harm to members of the group;
3. deliberately inflicting on the group conditions of life calculated to bring about its physical destruction in whole or in part;
4. imposing measures intended to prevent births within the group;
5. forcibly transferring children of the group to another group.

Not only genocide but also, conspiracy to commit genocide, inciting the public to commit genocide, attempt to commit genocide and complicity in the act are all punishable under the jurisdiction of the ICTY.²⁰

²⁰ *Mandate and crimes under ICTY jurisdiction*. Mandate and Crimes under ICTY Jurisdiction | International Criminal Tribunal for the former Yugoslavia. (n.d.). <https://www.icty.org/en/about/tribunal/mandate-and-crimes-under-icty-jurisdiction>

TIMELINE

- 1878 - The Serbo-Turkish Wars ended with Serbia defeating the Ottoman Empire and ratification of the Treaty of Berlin which recognized Serbia as an independent state.
- 28 June 1914 - Archduke Franz Ferdinand is assassinated in Sarajevo, Bosnia and Herzegovina triggering WW1.
- 20 July 1917 - As an aftermath of the First World War, the Corfu Agreement was signed between the Kingdom of Serbia and the Yugoslav Committee, composed of leaders from Croatia, Slovenia and Bosnia and Herzegovina. This laid the foundation for the Kingdom of Serbs, Croats and Slovenes
- 1 December 1918 - The Kingdom of the Serbs, Croats and Slovenes is officially formed.
- 6 January 1929- King Alexander dissolves the constitution, bans political parties based on region, religion and ethnicity, and establishes a monarchy dictatorship.
- 3 September 1931- The Octroyed Constitution was imposed and King Alexander I relinquished power.
- 9 October 1934- King Alexander is assassinated by a fascist revolutionary organisation in Marseille, France and is succeeded by Prince Paul, the regent of Peter II, legal heir of Yugoslavia who is not of age to rule the kingdom yet.
- 26 August 1939- The Banovina of Croatia was created, a region that was autonomous and self-governing.
- 1 September 1939 - German troops invade Poland marking the start of the Second World War.
- 25 March 1941 - Prince Paul signs the Tripartite Pact in Vienna, in an effort to keep Yugoslavia out of the war. But the public is displeased with this decision, and protests begin the very same day.
- 27 March 1941 - The Yugoslav military overthrows Prince Paul and declares King Peter II of age. Yugoslavia also backs out of the Tripartite Pact. These actions are supported by the British Government.
- 6 April 1941 - Axis forces invaded Yugoslavia, which capitulated 11 days later.
- 26 November 1942- Anti-Fascist Council for the National Liberation of Yugoslavia convenes in Bihać, consisting of the Royalist pro-Serbian Chetniks faction led by Draža Mihailović and the Communist Yugoslav Partisans led by Josip Broz Tito.
- 14 May 1945- The Yugoslav Partisans successfully drove out the Axis occupation of Yugoslavia, after a gruelling guerilla campaign.
- 13 November 1945- The People's Front wins all 354 seats in the elections, enabling the constituent assembly to depose King Peter II, leaving Tito in full control of Yugoslavia.
- 31 January 1946 - A new constitution comes into effect. The nation is renamed to the Federal People's Republic of Yugoslavia.
- 16 July 1946 - Draža Mihailović was captured and executed by Tito's government.

- 13 January 1953- The constitution is heavily amended, and emphasises more decentralisation and the Yugoslav-Soviet split occurs,
- 1 September 1961- Yugoslavia joins the Non-Aligned movement with India, Egypt, Indonesia and Ghana.
- 7 April 1963- Tito is named President for life and Yugoslavia is renamed to Socialist Federal Republic of Yugoslavia
- 17 February 1970- An event known as the Croat Spring took place, where students in Zagreb and the rest of Croatia protested for greater autonomy.
- 21 February 1974- A new constitution is ratified that gave more rights to individual republics in the country,
- 4 May 1980- Josip Broz Tito passes away leaving a huge power vacuum, leading to a rise in nationalist, and ethnic tension.
- 11 March 1981 - Pro-autonomy protests by ethnic Albanians start in Kosovo. The protesters wish to be out of Serbian control.
- 1988 - Slobodan Milošević launched the anti-bureaucratic movement which gained widespread support of the Serbs and eventually replaced the leaders of Kosovo and Vojvodina with his loyalists.
- 24 June 1991 - Slovenia and Croatia declare independence from Yugoslavia, initiating the breakup of the nation.
- 27 June 1991 - The Ten-Day War in Slovenia begins as the JNA attempts to suppress Slovenia's succession.
- 7 July 1991 - The Brioni Agreement is signed, marking the end of the Ten-Day War. The JNA is forced to withdraw making Slovenia the first republic to gain independence.
- 31 March 1991 - The Croatian Serbs with the help of the JNA defy the Croatian authorities and start taking control over Croatia marking the beginning of the Croatian War of Independence.
- 1 October 1991 - The JNA launches an offensive against Dubrovnik escalating the Croatian war and receives a strong response from the international community.
- 17 November, 1991 - Vukovar, a city in Croatia fell to the JNA, this was followed by a massacre of Croatian forces and civilians with many individuals being displaced.
- 14 January 1992 - Slovenia and Croatia are officially recognized as independent countries by the international community.
- 29 February 1992 - Bosnia and Herzegovina holds a referendum on independence.
- 4 April 1992 - Bosnia declares independence, leading to the start of the Bosnian War. Serbs established the self-proclaimed Republika Srpska. Shortly followed by the Croats who established the Croatian Republic of Herzeg-Bosnia.
- May 1992 - The UNPROFOR are deployed in Croatia to maintain a ceasefire.
- 22 September 1992 - The Federal Republic of Yugoslavia (Serbia and Montenegro) is barred from the UN until they apply and gain a new membership.
- October 1992 - The United Nations created safe areas in Bosnia, including Sarajevo and Srebrenica, which later

proved to be ineffective in protecting civilians.

- 16 January 1993 - The Vance-Owen Peace Plan was proposed.
- 22 February 1993: The United Nations Security Council (UNSC) passes Resolution 808, deciding to establish the International Criminal Tribunal for the former Yugoslavia (ICTY) to prosecute war crimes, crimes against humanity, and genocide committed during the Yugoslav Wars
- 31 March 1993: The UN Security Council adopts Resolution 816, authorising the enforcement of a no-fly zone over Bosnia and Herzegovina. NATO takes on this task, marking its first-ever military operation.
- May 22 1993: The UN Security Council establishes the International Criminal Tribunal for the former Yugoslavia (ICTY) with Resolution 827, officially setting up the legal framework to prosecute those responsible for war crimes.
- 9 July 1993: The Bosnian Serbs reject the Vance-Owen Peace Plan in a referendum.
- 14 September, 1993: UNGA, meets to address the situation in the former territory of Yugoslavia.

NOTABLE PERSONS

Franz Ferdinand

Archduke Franz Ferdinand was the heir presumptive to the Austro-Hungarian throne. His assassination on 28 June 1914 by a Serb nationalist in Bosnia and Herzegovina was the trigger for World War 1. His death set off a chain of conflicts and as an aftermath of WW1, the Kingdom of Serbs, Croats and Slovenes was born.²¹



Source: Bildarchiv Austria

Nikola Pašić

Nikola Pašić, former Prime Minister of the Kingdom of Serbia was one of the founders of the Kingdom of Serbs, Croats and Slovenes. His role was instrumental in advocating for the unification of the South Slavic people. Throughout his political career, he served five times as the prime minister of Serbia and three times as the prime minister of Yugoslavia.²²

²¹ Austria-Hungary. (n.d.-c). <https://www.britannica.com/place/Austria-Hungary>

²² Encyclopædia Britannica, inc. (n.d.). *Nikola Pašić*. Encyclopædia Britannica. <https://www.britannica.com/biography/Nikola-Pasic>



Source: The Balkan Cockpit

King Alexander I

King Alexander I played a crucial role in unifying the kingdom after World War 1. In 1929, he established a royal dictatorship in order to curb the rising ethnic divisions. As a part of his efforts to unify his subjects, he changed the country's name from the Kingdom of Serbs, Croats and Slovenes to Yugoslavia. His rule saw outlawing political parties based on ethnic, religious or regional distinctions and standardisation of legal systems, national holidays and learning curricula.²³



Source: Britannica

Stjepan Radić

Stjepan Radić was a prominent Croatian politician who advocated for greater autonomy for Croatia within Yugoslavia. In 1928, he was assassinated in the Yugoslav parliament by a politician from the Serbian People's Radical Party, this fueled widespread ethnic division between the Croats and Serbs.²⁴



Source: History of Croatia

Prince Paul

Prince Paul served as the regent of Yugoslavia. Seeing the growing threat of an Axis invasion, he signed the Tripartite pact on 21 March 1941 joining the Axis forces. This move by Prince Paul was not taken well by the public who protested against him on the same day. Just within two days

²³ Encyclopædia Britannica, inc. (n.d.-a). *Alexander I Summary*. Encyclopædia Britannica. <https://www.britannica.com/summary/Alexander-I-king-of-Yugoslavia>

²⁴ Encyclopædia Britannica, inc. (n.d.-c). *Stjepan Radić*. Encyclopædia Britannica. <https://www.britannica.com/biography/Stjepan-Radic>

of signing this pact, Prince Paul was overthrown by the military.²⁵



Source: The Royal Family of Serbia

King Peter II

Just at the age of 17, Peter II was declared of legal age to rule over Yugoslavia. He was immediately placed into power after the removal of Prince Paul. He was overthrown shortly after the Axis powers invaded Yugoslavia after they backed out of the Tripartite Pact. Proceeding the Axis invasion, Peter II escaped to London where he spent the rest of his life in exile.²⁶



Source: Imperial War Museums

Adolf Hitler

Adolf Hitler was the dictator of Nazi Germany. Displeased by the withdrawal of Yugoslavia from the Tripartite Pact and the appointment of King Peter II, he issued Fuhrer Directive 25 authorising German forces to invade Yugoslavia. On 6 April 1941, Yugoslavia was invaded by German forces backed by Italy. Yugoslavia was forced to surrender and fragmented. The German forces also gave rise to its puppet Ustaše regime in Croatia which facilitated genocide and committed many crimes against humanity like ethnic cleansing.²⁷

²⁵ HRH Prince Paul of Yugoslavia (regent). The Royal Family of Serbia. (2013, September 24). <https://royalfamily.org/dynasty/hrh-prince-paul-of-yugoslavia-regent/>

²⁶ HM king Peter II of Yugoslavia. The Royal Family of Serbia. (2024, June 30). <https://royalfamily.org/dynasty/hm-king-peter-ii-of-yugoslavia/>

²⁷ Axis Invasion of Yugoslavia. United States holocaust memorial museum. (n.d.). <https://encyclopedia.ushmm.org/content/en/article/axis-invasion-of-yugoslavia>



Source: The Guardian

Josip Broz Tito

Tito was the leader of the Yugoslav Partisans and the President of the Socialist Federal Republic of Yugoslavia. He played a crucial role in the resistance against Axis occupation during WWII. Under his rule, he repressed all ethnic division and the country saw great economic growth. His death in 1980 marked the beginning of Yugoslavia's fall.²⁸



Source: Blic

Dragoljub Draža Mihailović

Draža Mihailović was the leader of the Chetniks, a Serbian nationalistic resistance group which fought against the Axis occupation and the Ustaše regime. However, the Chetniks lost focus on their main goal and were involved in conflicts and the killing of many Communist Partisans. Draža was later captured and executed by Tito's government.²⁹



Source: Kingdom-of-Yugoslavia-in-WW2

Ante Pavelić

Ante Pavelić was the leader of the Ustaše and Head of the Independent State of Croatia (NDH). During his rule over this Nazi-backed puppet state of Croatia, Pavelić orchestrated and facilitated ethnic cleansing and genocide against Jewish, Serb and Roma populations. Individuals suspected to have resentment against the fascist powers were also sent to detention camps and executed.³⁰

²⁸ Encyclopædia Britannica, inc. (2024, September 11). *Josip Broz Tito*. Encyclopædia Britannica. <https://www.britannica.com/biography/Josip-Broz-Tito>

²⁹ Encyclopædia Britannica, inc. (n.d.-b). *Dragoljub Mihailović*. Encyclopædia Britannica. <https://www.britannica.com/biography/Dragoljub-Mihailovic>

³⁰ United States Holocaust Memorial Museum. (n.d.-b). ANTE PAVELIĆ. United States Holocaust Memorial Museum. <https://encyclopedia.ushmm.org/content/en/film/croatian-fascist-leader-ante-pavelic>



Source: Balkan Insight

Slobodan Milošević

Slobodan Milošević was the President of Serbia and a dominant figure in the Yugoslav conflicts. He was a Serbian nationalist who wanted to centralise power in Yugoslavia and sought to maintain Serbian dominance over the other republics. He also supported the Bosnian Serbs to rebel against the Bosnian government. He also rallied Serbs in Kosovo against the ethnic Albanians and deepened ethnic tensions in the region. He launched the Anti-Bureaucratic Revolution and replaced the leadership of Vojvodina, Kosovo and Montenegro with his loyalists. This attempt to centralise power was one of the key factors leading to Yugoslavia's breakup.³¹



Source: Balkan Insight

Radovan Karadžić

Radovan Karadžić was the leader of the Bosnia Serbs during the conflicts in Bosnia and Herzegovina. With the support of Serbia and the JNA, he captured parts of Bosnia and Herzegovina in 1992 and declared those regions as a part of Republika Srpska, an independent Serbian nation within Bosnia. This newly formed republic committed ethnic cleansing against Bosnian Croats and Muslims, creating the most brutal and prolonged conflict in the Yugoslav wars and forcefully displaced thousands of civilians from their homes. Due to the violent actions and nature of the formation of this new republic, it failed to gain international recognition. Karadžić served as the President of Republika Srpska since its foundation.³²

³¹ Slobodan Milošević. (n.d.-i).

https://www.icty.org/x/cases/slobodan_milosevic/cis/en/cis_milosevic_slobodan_en.pdf

³² Encyclopædia Britannica, inc. (2024a, September 6). *Radovan Karadžić*. Encyclopædia Britannica.

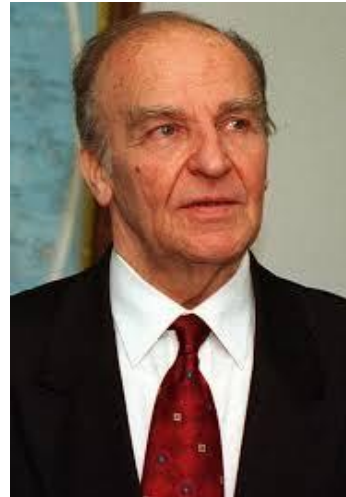
<https://www.britannica.com/biography/Radovan-Karadzic>



Source: Britannica

Alija Izetbegović

Alija Izetbegović served as the President of Bosnia and Herzegovina since 1990. Despite facing overwhelming challenges from Serb and Croat nationalists, he sought a united and multi-ethnic Bosnia. He believed that all Slavs could coexist together despite having different ethnicities. He withdrew from the Lisbon agreement and rejected the Vance-Stoltenberg plan which aimed to divide Bosnia and Herzegovina into territories on the basis of ethnicity or population. He received promises from the international community to recognise Bosnia and Herzegovina within its original boundaries, was an advocate for Bosnian independence and sought international intervention to stop the war.³³



Source: Treccani

Mate Boban

Mate Boban served as the leader of the Croatian Republic of Herzeg-Bosnia. He led the Bosnian Croats in their efforts to establish an autonomous Croat republic within Bosnia during the conflict. Just like the Republika Srpska, the Croatian Republic of Herzeg-Bosnia failed to receive international support.



Source: US State Department of Defense

Cyrus Vance

Cyrus Vance served as the UN's Special Envoy to Yugoslavia. He co-chaired multiple conferences in the International Conference on Former

³³ Encyclopædia Britannica, inc. (2024c, September 13). *Bosnian War*. Encyclopædia Britannica. <https://www.britannica.com/event/Bosnian-War>

Yugoslavia held in Geneva. Vance co-authored several peace plans during the Yugoslav Wars, but his efforts to negotiate peace were largely unsuccessful due to disagreement among the republics. Vance's efforts were also a part of the United Nations Protection Force (UNPROFOR) mission which was successful in catering a ceasefire within Croatia starting on 3 January 1992 and successfully deployed around fourteen thousand UN peacekeepers in Serb-occupied territories of Croatia which helped freeze much of the frontlines of the conflict.³⁴



Source: US Government

Thorvald Stoltenberg

Stoltenberg replaced Vance as a UN Special Envoy to the former Yugoslavia in 1993. He co-authored the Stoltenberg-Owen Plan, which sought to divide Bosnia and Herzegovina into three ethnic states—a Bosniak, Serb, and Croat entity. He aimed to secure safe zones and humanitarian corridors to assist civilians stuck in crossfire, particularly in Bosnia and Herzegovina.³⁵

Lord David Owen

Lord David Owen co-chaired the International Conference on the Former Yugoslavia (ICFY) starting in 1992. He met leaders of various factions to broker peace. He co-authored plans like the Vance-Owen Plan and the Owen-Stoltenberg Plan to achieve peace within the territory of Yugoslavia. Despite multiple challenges, he remained committed to resolving the conflict and met various regional leaders like Slobodan Milošević, Franjo Tuđman, and Alija Izetbegović in an attempt to broker a ceasefire.



Source: UK Parliament

Boris Yeltsin

Boris Yeltsin served as the first President of the Russian Federation in 1991 after the collapse of the Soviet Union. Boris used Russia's historical ties as a region to carry out peaceful negotiations. While Russia had strong historical ties with Serbia and favoured Serbian nationalism, Yeltsin presented himself as a mediator to the international community. Boris' government was involved in multiple UN and European initiatives aiming to prevent the escalation of violence and encourage dialogue.

³⁴ United Nations. (n.d.). UNPROFOR. United Nations. https://peacekeeping.un.org/mission/past/unprof_b.htm

³⁵ Thorvald Stoltenberg. European Leadership Network. (n.d.). <https://europeanleadershipnetwork.org/person/thorvald-stoltenberg/>



Source: Kremlin

COUNTRY STANCES

The United States of America

The United States of America had an evolving approach to the Yugoslav Wars. Initially, refraining from taking any military intervention, the US did support the use of economic sanctions on the Federal Republic of Yugoslavia (FRY). In 1992, Bill Clinton, then Governor of Arkansas started advocating for active American involvement in the support of the Bosnians. When Clinton became President in 1993, the former Yugoslavia ranked high on the list of foreign policy concerns. In 1993, with its allies in NATO, the US helped the UN by enforcing an arms embargo on the FRY and assisted in the creation of a no-fly zone over the disputed region.

The Russian Federation

The Russian Federation was born on 12 December 1991. Boris Yeltsin, the first President of Russia supported the diplomatic talks by the UN instead of military action. Russia recognized the independent republics while maintaining close

ties with Serbia. As the war escalated, Russia leaned towards supporting the Serbian interests. The Russian Federation was involved in multiple UN and European initiatives aiming to prevent the escalation of violence and encourage dialogue.

United Kingdom

The United Kingdom has a complex role in the Yugoslav Wars. Foreign secretary Douglas Hurd was a primary architect of the West's policy to maintain a unified Yugoslavia, and urged the republics to remain in the Yugoslav Federation. However, allegedly eight days before Slovenia, the first breakaway state, declared independence from the Federal Republic of Yugoslavia, a British firm delivered communications equipment to Slovenian forces. These were used against the Serb-led Yugoslav army. Racal, a British manufacturer of military equipment and the Slovenian defence ministry were engaged in a multi million pound deal, which saw communications equipment being sent to the Slovenian army³⁶. Operation Grapple was British boots on Yugoslav soil, and were mainly tasked with protecting aid convoys, and were highly effective in this endeavour thanks to their prior experience in Northern Ireland.³⁷

Croatia

Croatia declared independence on 24 June, 1991. It immediately faced resistance from the Serbian minority supported by the JNA. This turned into a large-scale conflict which forced many Croats and ethnic Hungarians to migrate to Hungary. Croatia also supported the Croatian Republic of Herzeg-Bosnia which failed to gain international recognition.

³⁶ Zentrum für Osteuropa- und internationale Studien. (2021, June 10). *Ten Days that ended Yugoslavia: The Forgotten War in Slovenia, 30 years later*. Zentrum für Osteuropa- und internationale Studien (ZOiS). <https://www.zois-berlin.de/en/publications/ten-days-that-ended-yugoslavia-the-forgotten-war-in-slovenia-30-years-later>

³⁷ Bosnia. National Army Museum. (n.d.). <https://www.nam.ac.uk/explore/bosnia>

Federal Republic of Yugoslavia

The Federal Republic of Yugoslavia (FRY) comprised Serbia and Montenegro. The FRY backed the self-proclaimed Republika Srpska in Bosnia and the Republic of Serbian Krajina in Croatia. The FRY termed the succession of Slovenia, Croatia, and Bosnia and Herzegovina as “illegitimate”. The rebels in Croatia and Bosnia were even assisted by the JNA. These Serbian

forces committed many human right violations and targeted civilians of other ethnicities. Seeing this, the FRY was sanctioned by the UN and was subject to an arms embargo. By 1993, it was decided that the FRY would not be permitted to inherit the UN membership of the former Socialist Federal Republic of Yugoslavia (SFRY) and would be barred from participating in the UNGA until this membership was granted.